

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 10, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 14:13-25

13 Therefore let him who speaks in a tongue pray that he may interpret.

14 For if I pray in a tongue, my spirit prays, but my understanding is unfruitful.

15 What is the conclusion then? I will pray with the spirit, and I will also pray with the understanding. I will sing with the spirit, and I will also sing with the understanding.

16 Otherwise, if you bless with the spirit, how will he who occupies the place of the uninformed say "Amen" at your giving of thanks, since he does not understand what you say?

17 For you indeed give thanks well, but the other is not edified.

18 I thank my God I speak with tongues more than you all;

19 yet in the church I would rather speak five words with my understanding, that I may teach others also, than ten thousand words in a tongue.

20 Brethren, do not be children in understanding; however, in malice be babes, but in understanding be mature.

21 In the law it is written: "With men of other tongues and other lips I will speak to this people; And yet, for all that, they will not hear Me," says the Lord.

22 Therefore tongues are for a sign, not to those who believe but to unbelievers; but prophesying is not for unbelievers but for those who believe.

23 Therefore if the whole church comes together in one place, and all speak with tongues, and there come in those who are uninformed or unbelievers, will they not say that you are out of your mind?

24 But if all prophesy, and an unbeliever or an uninformed person comes in, he is convinced by all, he is convicted by all.

25 And thus the secrets of his heart are revealed; and so, falling down on his face, he will

worship God and report that God is truly among you.

II. Key Summary

- Paul states that the one who speaks in a tongue should pray for the ability to interpret, because praying in a tongue leaves the understanding unfruitful (vv. 13–14)
 - Paul would rather speak five intelligible words in church than ten thousand words in a tongue, because others cannot say "Amen" or be edified by what they cannot understand (vv. 16–19)
 - Paul describes how an unbeliever who enters a gathering and hears prophecy will have the secrets of his heart revealed, and will fall down and worship, declaring that God is truly present (vv. 24–25)
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III. Passage Analysis

Prayer Engages Both the Spirit and the Mind

"Paul saw great value in the gift of tongues for his own devotional life before the Lord: yet, when he gathered with other Christians, his concern was to be a blessing, not with getting a blessing." [1]

Paul was not against tongues — he spoke in tongues more than anyone in Corinth. But he knew that five words others could understand were worth far more in a church setting than ten thousand words no one could follow. Faith is not just a private thing between you and God; it also involves whether the people around you can be brought into that same experience.

Clear Truth Is What Opens an Outsider's Heart

"A heathen or unlearned person couldn't benefit from incomprehensible teaching — conscience and conviction require clear, understandable communication of Gospel truths." [2]

Paul pictures an outsider walking into a gathering, hearing truth spoken plainly, and suddenly having the hidden things of his heart exposed — so much so that he falls on his face and says, "God is truly among you." Being understood is where others meeting God

begins.

IV. Reflection Question

When you talk about your faith, do you say it in a way your friends can actually understand — or do you assume it's just something only you would get?

Paul says that when truth is spoken clearly, an outsider's deepest secrets are laid bare and they fall down saying, "God is truly among you" — being understood is where others meeting God begins.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-14/>

[2] BibleHub.com, Matthew Henry Commentary,

https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/14-20.htm